

FIELD LIBRARY / SUPPLY WORKSHEET

Emergency water storage

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

BUILD AROUND YOUR HOUSEHOLD

Use what you own first. Match quantities to people, days and medical needs. Supplies are preparation, never a reason to delay escape.

HOUSEHOLD / PEOPLE / PETS

PLANNING PERIOD / AVAILABLE BUDGET

01	Commercially bottled water or food-grade storage containers	Have: _____ Need: _____
02	Labels and permanent marker	Have: _____ Need: _____
03	Additional water for pets and medical needs	Have: _____ Need: _____

Make it workable.

BUY / BORROW / SHARE

Mark essentials before optional equipment. Choose supplies you can carry, store and use safely. Check compatibility, expiry dates and instructions; no product or retailer is endorsed.

BUY FIRST / ESTIMATED COST

BORROW OR SHARE / CONTACT

CARRY AND STORAGE LIMITS

EXPIRY / REFILL / BATTERY CHECKS

Household considerations.

Build the plan around the least mobile person and the shortest critical supply. Try carrying the kit, opening containers and using the light in the dark. Spend first on safe water, essential medicines, basic food and communication rather than specialised gear you cannot use. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: calculate needs. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Do not reuse containers that held toxic substances, even after washing.

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Emergency water storage · official guidance](#)

<https://www.cdc.gov/water-emergency/about/how-to-create-and-store-an-emergency-water-supply.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/water-storage/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.